rannjan), *to run, gallop*, with metathesis of **r** and preservation of the older stage of umlaut.

§ **61.** Nasals disappeared before the voiceless spirants, **f, þ, s,** and the preceding **a** (o) became **ō** through the intermediate stage of a long nasalized vowel (cp. § **40**), as **hōs**, Goth. OHG. **hansa**, *band, escort, multitude*; **ōþer**, Goth. **anþar**, *second, other*; **sōfte**, OHG. **samfto**, *gently, softly*; and similarly **gōs**, *goose*; **ōs-**, *god*; **ōsle** (OHG. **amsala**), *blackbird*; **smōþe**, *smoothly*; **sōþ**, *true*; **tōþ**, *tooth*; **þrōstle**, *thrush, throstle*; **wōs**, *moisture*.

§ **62.** **ō** became **ē** (older **œ**) by **i**-umlaut, as **ēst**, Goth. **ansts**, stem-form **ansti-**, *favour*; **nēþan**, Goth. **ana-nanþjan**, *to venture on*; **tēþ** from ***tanþiz**, *teeth*; and similarly **fēþe**, *walking, movement*; **gēs**, *geese*; **gesēþan**, *to testify, declare*; **sēfte**, *soft*; **smēþe**, *smooth*.

§ **63.** **a** was broken to **ea** before **l, r,** and **h** + consonant, and before simple **h**. Forms without breaking often occur in the oldest period of the language. Breaking did not take place in Anglian before **l** + consonant, and frequently not before **r** + consonant. See **l, r** (§ **7**).

§ **64.** 1. Before **l** + consonant.

eall, Goth. **alls**, O.Icel. **allr**, OS. OHG. **al**, *all*; **ceald**, Goth. **kalds**, O.Icel. **kaldr**, OS. **kald**, OHG. **kalt**, *cold*; **healdan**, Goth. OS. **haldan**, O.Icel. **halda**, OHG. **haltan**, *to hold*; and similarly **cealc**, *chalk*; **cealf**, *calf*; **dealf**, *he dug*; **eald**, *old*; **ealh**, *temple*; **fealdan**, *to fold*; **feallan**, *to fall*; **gealga**, *gallows*; **healf**, *half*; **heall**, *hall*; **healp**, *he helped*; **heals**, *neck*; **mealt**, *malt*; **sealf**, *salve, ointment*; **sealfian**, *to anoint*; **sealh**, *willow*; **sealt**, *salt*; **tealde**, *he told*; **wealdan**, *to wield*; **wealh**, *foreigner, Welshman*; **weall**, *wall*; **weallan**, *to boil*. Forms like **bealu**, *bale, evil*; **fealu**, *fallow*; **sealu**, *dark, dusky*, beside **balu, falu, salu**, have the **ea** from the inflected stem-form, as gen. **bealwes, fealwes, sealwes** (see § **265**).

NOTE.—1. **ea** became **ēa** by loss of **h** before a following